

SUSTAINABLE COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT THROUGH PEER-TO-PEER LEARNING

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Abstract

When starting a new skill, beginners often struggle a lot because they don't have experienced people to guide them. Today, most online learning is just watching videos by yourself, which lacks the real human interaction people actually need to improve. To fix this gap, our app connects beginners who want to learn with veterans who are willing to share their knowledge. The app covers a wide variety of skills, and users can learn and build communities at any time of the day. Because it is online, you can use it anywhere depending on what skill you are practicing. It is made for everyone. If you are a beginner, you can just browse the app for a skill you like and join a group. On the flip side, if you are an expert who wants to help others, you can easily create your own group on the app and start guiding people right away.

Keywords:

Community development, peer-to-peer learning, learning by doing.

I. Introduction:

Digital learning made information universally accessible, but accessibility doesn't always guarantee mastery. This is generally experienced by Self-taught learners, hobbyists, and professionals looking to upskill; consuming one-way content (like pre-recorded videos or text modules, YouTube tutorials, etc.). The gap is felt mostly when a learner makes a mistake or encounters a bug they cannot figure out how to fix on their own or when initial excitement fades, and the isolation of learning alone causes motivation to drop or when the learner tries to apply the knowledge acquired in real-life scenarios and needs a feedback on his/her work.

To address this, we propose a community application where people can come forward to help others learn skills – for free. Instead of formal, high-pressure teaching, it relies on shared routines.

II. Literature Review:

A recent study states there's a critical role of interactive, peer-to-peer learning activities in overcoming limitations faced by traditional, isolated e-learning. Campbell explains how peer-to-peer learning helps in community development as the learners actively support one another.

The necessity of this community-driven approach becomes even clearer when examining the psychological drawbacks of unguided online learning. Digital learning without human interaction leads to increased feelings of loneliness, low attention span, etc. Effective modern learning must go beyond this isolated content consumption. Our application fixes these problems with a digital interface strictly as a discovery tool to initiate physical, peer-to-peer skill-sharing sessions, transforming passive learners into active, supported community participants.

Reference:

Campbell, J., Shaul, K., Slagle, K. M., & Sovic, D. (2024). Sustainable community development through peer-to-peer learning in the online and in-person classroom. *International Journal of Sustainability in Higher Education*, 25(8), 1803–1819. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSHE-07-2023-0321>

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